Daily Content Intel

August 27, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

A coach I know saves speed and jump work for the end of practice. Doing it first gave players 70% more jump improvement in the same 6 weeks.

Here's the study. 22 trained young soccer players, split into two groups. Six weeks in-season, two sessions a week, same total work for everybody. One group did the neuromuscular work first, the jumps and the sprints and the landing mechanics, then played small-sided games. The other group played first and did the neuromuscular work after.

Both groups improved. The neuromuscular-first group improved more on almost everything. Five-jump test went up 17% instead of 10%. Ten meter sprint improved 10% instead of 6%. Change of direction with the ball got 7% better, and the other group barely moved.

It's 22 kids, so I'm not going to oversell one study. But the logic holds up. Speed and power are nervous system qualities, and your nervous system is freshest at the start. Fatigue it with games first and you're training a tired athlete.

So Monday, move it. Warm up, then jumps and sprints, then play. Same practice. Different order.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: A coach I know saves speed and jump work for the end of practice. Doing it first gave players 70% more jump improvement in the same 6 weeks.

Spoken script (word for word):

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 70% more jump improvement. Same 6 weeks.
- 0:08 22 players. Same work. Different order.
- 0:22 Neuromuscular first, then games
- 0:34 Five-jump: +17% vs +10%
- 0:40 10m sprint: -10% vs -6%
- 0:46 COD with ball: -7% vs -1%
- 0:58 Speed is a nervous system quality
- 1:10 Warm up. Jump and sprint. Then play.

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Same practice. Same total work. Different order. Different result.

22 trained youth soccer players ran 6 in-season weeks of neuromuscular training and small-sided games. The only variable was which one came first.

The group that did jumps, sprints and landing work before games improved more on almost every measure. Five-jump test up 17% versus 10%. Ten meter sprint improved 10% versus 6%. Change of direction with the ball improved 7%, while the games-first group barely moved.

It's a small study on young players, so I'm holding it loosely. But it lines up with what I see in the weight room. Speed and power are nervous system qualities, and the nervous system is freshest at the start of a session.

If you coach, this one costs you nothing to test. Move the speed work to the front and keep everything else the same.

It's time to cross your threshold.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT
threshold.clientsecure.me

#speedtraining #footballtraining #lacrosse #strengthandconditioning #youthathlete #athleticperformance #sportsperformance #hsfootball #speeddevelopment #coaching

Personalize this

- You program HS football strength work around practice you don't control. Where does the speed and plyo block actually land in your athletes' week right now, and how often does it end up after conditioning because that's the time that was left?
- Give a specific athlete: someone whose jump or 10 meter numbers moved once you put the neuromuscular work at the front of the session instead of the back. What did the number do?
- Coaches push back that speed work at the front "takes away from practice." What's your actual answer to that in a conversation with a head coach, and has it worked?

Shoot notes:

- The brief's drop-off frames all show a flat expression and a busy gym background with windows behind the subject. Shoot this one against the cleanest wall you have, subject off-center, and keep the gym out of frame entirely.

- Frame tight from mid-chest up and crop the empty space above your head. Two of the three logged drop-offs had a plain ceiling or blank wall eating the top half of the frame.
- The first line has the number in it, so land it. Be already talking with energy on frame 1, no breath-in, no settling. If you fluff the first sentence, re-roll rather than trimming into it.

Hook shape: Story hook — brief line: "A story hook is skipped 3.2 points less than your average across 4 reels. It survives the scroll better than anything else you open with." The concrete coach scene opens it, and the 70% claim lands inside the same hook so there's no wind-up.

Screenshots:

- title | https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42647360/ | "Training Sequence Matters:

Neuromuscular Training Followed by Small-Sided Games Enhances Physical Fitness and Soccer-Specific Performance in Prepubertal Soccer Players"

- physiology | https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42647360/ | "the magnitude of improvement was consistently greater when neuromuscular training preceded small-sided games"
- actionable | https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42647360/ | "performing neuromuscular training before SSG resulted in greater improvements in several physical fitness and soccer-specific performance outcomes"

Sources:

- https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42647360/
- https://doi.org/10.3390/jfmk11030319

Topic B — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

76% of athletes who say their knee feels ready a year after ACL surgery still have a quad that tests weak.

That's a new study out of Marseille. 90 people, all a year out from ACL reconstruction. They filled out the standard questionnaire, the one that asks how the knee feels with sport and with daily life. Then they got tested on an isokinetic machine, both legs, measured side to side.

Of the people who cleared the questionnaire threshold, 76% still had a quad more than 10% weaker than the other leg. The agreement between how the knee felt and how the quad actually measured was basically zero.

And I get why. Pain settles down long before strength comes back, and a knee that stops hurting feels like a knee that's finished.

Here's my position. Feeling good earns you the right to keep progressing. Objective testing is what earns you the right to be done.

A lot of athletes get discharged on a conversation, because the conversation sounds great. Your quad doesn't care how ready you feel. Test it side to side, then test it again under fatigue.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: 76% of athletes who say their knee feels ready a year after ACL surgery still have a quad that tests weak.

Spoken script (word for word):

76% of athletes who say their knee feels ready a year after ACL surgery still have a quad that tests weak.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 76% felt ready. Their quad wasn't.
- 0:10 90 patients, 1 year post-ACL
- 0:20 Questionnaire vs isokinetic testing
- 0:32 Agreement: basically zero
- 0:44 Pain leaves before strength returns
- 0:56 Feeling good = keep going
- 1:02 Testing = you're done
- 1:12 Test side to side. Then under fatigue.

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Feeling ready and being ready are two different measurements.

90 patients, 1 year out from ACL reconstruction. Researchers compared the patient-reported score, the one that asks how your knee feels with sport and with life, against isokinetic quad testing side to side.

Of the athletes who cleared the questionnaire threshold, 76% still had a quad more than 10% weaker than the uninvolved leg. Statistical agreement between the two was near zero, and it held across every graft type.

Pain settles down long before strength comes back. That gap is where reinjury lives.

Feeling good earns you the right to keep progressing. Objective testing is what earns you the right to be done. If your quad hasn't been measured side to side, you have a conversation, and you don't have a clearance.

It's time to cross your threshold.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT
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#aclrehab #aclrecovery #returntosport #physicaltherapy #sportsrehab #athletetraining #kneerehab #lacrosse #footballtraining #strengthandconditioning

Personalize this

- Name a return-to-sport call you made where the athlete told you the knee felt fine and the testing disagreed. What did you test, what was the number, and what did you tell them?
- What's your actual battery for clearing a knee at Threshold? Walk through strength symmetry side to side, hop and jump

testing, change of direction under fatigue and psychological readiness, in the order you run them.

- You've had athletes arrive already "cleared" by someone else. How do you have that conversation with the athlete and the parent without trashing the previous provider?

Shoot notes:

- This one is an opinion piece, so energy is the whole thing. The logged drop-offs all read "low energy, flat expression." Stand up to film it, get your voice up before you roll, and let the face move on "basically zero" and on "Test it."
- Clean background again, no gym equipment or windows behind you. Solid wall, you off-center, tight crop with no dead ceiling space.
- The 76% is the first thing out of your mouth. Start mid-energy on an already-moving sentence, hold the beat after "still have a quad that tests weak," then go.

Hook shape: Statement hook — brief line: "Viewers bail at 0-8s (median 27.5pp drop) ... Put the payoff in the first line, not after a wind-up." The gate permits a statement opener when the first line carries the claim itself, and here the number leads the sentence. Deliberately steered away from the story shape for this one because the flagged reel "A Division I lacrosse player asked me what to do with his bad knee during ACL rehab. I stopped him" (77.1% skip) is the same ACL-anecdote setup pattern.

Screenshots:

- title | https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42647020/ | "Patient-reported acceptable symptom state does not reflect quadriceps symmetry 1 year after ACL reconstruction"
- physiology | https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42647020/ | "Among patients who reached the KOOS Sport PASS threshold, 76% had concurrent quadriceps LSI scores below

90%."

- actionable | https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42647020/ | "a satisfactory PROM result alone should not be taken as evidence of restored quadriceps symmetry"

Sources:

- https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42647020/
- https://doi.org/10.1002/ksa.70584

Reference

Runner-up topics

- Sprint exposure as hamstring prevention: scoping review reports 56% to 94% injury reduction when sprint exposure is combined with eccentric strength and mechanics work (MDPI Applied Sciences 15(16):9003). Heavy overlap with the 2026-08-11 "run fast" citation, so it needs a fresh angle.
- "Coffee and Physical Performance: What Is Driven by Caffeine and What Is Not" (Nutrients, 2026 Aug 18, PMID 42654270). Clean myth-buster for the pre-game coffee habit.
- Lateral jump-landing test with dual-task at return-to-sport (Phys Ther Sport, 2026 Aug 18, PMID 42617458). Held back because a dual-task RTS paper was cited 2026-08-21.

Sources scanned today

- Newsletter digest (newsletter_digest_2026-08-27.pdf): 2 sources, both unusable. Dr. Mercola issue was ad-dominated promo (pregnenolone/DHEA, NAC, magnesium) with no study behind it. Mike T. Nelson's issue was a personal essay about a Reston mastermind plus a lecture-bundle pitch; the one linked article was a product page and its classifier errored out (Anthropic API credit balance, 400). No clinical findings pulled from the digest today.

- PubMed, last 9-10 days, athlete-biased queries: resistance training in adolescent athletes, return to sport / ACL, sprint performance in team sport, hamstring, football training load, high school athletes, in-season training, change of direction, lacrosse. ~60 records screened.
- Web scan: hamstring injury prevention and sprint exposure (MDPI scoping review), sleep extension in collegiate and adolescent athletes, cold water immersion and resistance training adaptations.
- BJSM direct browse returned no specific August 2026 youth-athlete item through search; skipped.

- PubMed and MDPI both refuse scripted fetches (HTTP 203 / 403), so verbatim targets were taken from the NCBI efetch abstract record per the NCBI abstract rule. The screenshot script drives a real browser and renders the abstract view.
- Blocked by dedup: "Single-Night Sleep Extension Enhances Morning Physical and Cognitive Performance" (PMC12387293) was already cited 2026-07-21. Dropped.